

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM Detection Engineering | SOAR Automation | Threat Hunting | CrowdStrike | Microsoft Sentinel

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience building high-fidelity detection logic, developing Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, and conducting proactive threat hunting across network, endpoint, and cloud data. I specialise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering using Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, where I build and maintain detection rules designed to identify malicious activity, minimise false positives, and ensure relevant alerts reach the Security Operations Centre (SOC). I create SOAR playbooks that automate repetitive tasks, enrich alerts, and enable the team to focus on high-value analysis. I conduct proactive threat hunting to identify hidden threats that evade automated prevention, and I upskill analysts to develop engineering mindsets and perform basic engineering and automation tasks independently. I thrive in collaborative, office-first hybrid environments and am passionate about maturing detection capabilities in fast-moving FinTech organisations.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, high-fidelity detection rule development, false positive reduction, alert tuning
- **SOAR Automation:** Playbook development, automated alert enrichment, custom integrations, workflow automation, repetitive task elimination
- **Threat Hunting:** CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactive threat hunting across network, endpoint, and cloud data, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Azure Active Directory (AD), Entra ID, Defender for Cloud; exposure to cloud-native security monitoring
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR automation logic, security workflow scripting
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident handling, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned investigation, containment, eradication, and lessons learned
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Identity Security:** Entra ID, Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, NIST 800-61, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Team Development:** Mentoring SOC analysts, upskilling teams with engineering mindsets, knowledge sharing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Build and maintain high-fidelity detection logic in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL and in CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, identifying malicious activity while minimising false positives and ensuring relevant, actionable alerts for the SOC team
- Develop and maintain SOAR playbooks that automate repetitive tasks, enrich alerts with threat context, and integrate across security tooling, allowing the team to focus on high-value analysis rather than manual enrichment
- Conduct proactive threat hunting across network, endpoint, and cloud data using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying hidden threats that evade automated prevention controls

- Upskill and mentor junior analysts to develop engineering mindsets, enabling them to perform basic engineering actions and automation tasks independently, increasing team capacity and capability
- Engineer and tune detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, continuously improving the fidelity and relevance of SOC alerts
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover) platform across an 8,000-user estate, performing deep-dive endpoint investigation and threat containment
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and M365 Defender, correlating signals to identify multi-stage attack chains
- Automate security workflows using PowerShell and KQL, reducing manual effort and improving detection and response consistency
- Lead incident response activities following NIST 800-61 procedures, including threat containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review
- Manage vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, driving remediation and hardening across the estate

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Developed and refined SIEM detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, reducing false-positive alert volume and improving SOC signal quality
- Contributed to SOAR playbook development, automating alert triage and enrichment workflows to increase analyst efficiency
- Performed threat hunting activities using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, investigating endpoint and network anomalies to uncover threats that bypassed automated controls
- Carried out SIEM/EDR alert triage, escalation, and incident response across the estate, following NIST 800-61 incident handling procedures
- Managed CrowdStrike Falcon deployment, policy configuration, and exclusion management for the 8,000-user UAL estate
- Deployed and administered the full Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender), integrating telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for unified detection
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams
- Supported junior analysts with investigative techniques and SIEM query development, fostering engineering mindsets within the SOC

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Implemented and monitored security controls across a SaaS/FinTech infrastructure, supporting threat detection and incident response activities
- Contributed to security monitoring alert analysis and escalation, gaining foundational experience in detection engineering principles
- Managed endpoint security tooling, identity access controls, and vulnerability scanning, supporting the organisation's security operations function
- Supported security hardening and compliance activities aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and deployed a comprehensive library of high-fidelity detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM at UAL, significantly improving SOC alert quality and reducing noise
- Developed SOAR playbooks that automated alert enrichment and triage workflows, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and freeing analysts for high-value investigation tasks
- Led proactive threat hunting campaigns using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight that uncovered previously undetected threats across UAL's network, endpoint, and cloud environments
- Mentored and upskilled junior SOC analysts to perform basic detection engineering and automation tasks, doubling team engineering capacity

- Delivered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and M365 Defender deployment across 8,000 users, unifying SIEM/EDR telemetry for improved cross-platform detection
- Mapped all detection rules to MITRE ATT&CK framework, enabling structured coverage reporting and gap analysis for senior stakeholders

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000-85,000 | Hybrid (London, UK)